POETRY RECITAL

Choose a poem/song of **no less than 14 lines** to recite to the class. Be selective in your choice – i.e. **choose a meaningful poem/song** that is not too childish or too complicated.

You will need to introduce your poem in a speech (follow the traditional steps in presenting a speech, including the use of cue cards). This should be about 2 – 2 ½ minutes long. In your introduction you will give some **background** on the poet/songwriter and the era/context in which the poem/song was written. Tell the audience what the **poem is about/ the intention of the poet**, and **how the poem speaks to you personally** (why you chose it). You may need to **explain some of the language, and draw the audience's attention to ideas/images** that you feel require attention. **Do not present an AI summary.**

It is recommended that you use a known poet/songwriter, as there will be more information on the poem, poet and context for your introduction, and it is more likely to be of a high calibre.

A good website to browse for poems is : www.poetryfoundation.org or https://www.poetryoutloud.org/

- **Remember that the way in which you present your speech and poem (posture, confidence, audience awareness, voice projection, pronunciation, variation in tone and fluency) is as important as the content. This level of competence can only be achieved with preparation – you need to PRACTISE, PRACTISE, PRACTISE.**
- **You MUST add a little DRAMA to add spice to your recitation (USE GESTURES AND PROPS) that you feel they add to the message. You may also play soft music in the background. You may not sing your song/poem – it must be spoken and we must hear the words.**
- **Be careful of your diction, and note which words may be found offensive, you may need to warn your audience before using these.**
- **You will not be allowed to read. Effective use of cue cards with words/phrases on them is encouraged for the introduction.**
- **Provide a written copy of your poem and the speech to your teacher.**

Due date: _____